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Online Store Product Pricing Calculator Template

Pricing your products can feel overwhelming when you are just starting to sell online. Should you charge ₦15,000 or ₦18,000? How do you know if you are actually making money after all...



6 pages · PDF

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Pricing your products can feel overwhelming when you are just starting to sell online. Should you charge ₦15,000 or ₦18,000? How do you know if you are actually making money after all your costs? That is where a product pricing calculator becomes your best friend.

This simple toolkit shows you how to build and use a pricing calculator that takes the guesswork out of setting profitable prices. No complex formulas or accounting degree needed, just simple maths that protects your profit.

01 What Is a Product Pricing Calculator?

A product pricing calculator is a simple tool (usually a spreadsheet) that helps you find the right selling price by adding up all your costs and the profit margin you want. Profit margin is the share of the selling price you keep as profit. Instead of guessing, you enter real numbers and the calculator shows you exactly what to charge.

Think of it as your pricing safety net. It makes sure you are not losing money on every sale, a common mistake when new sellers forget some of their costs.

02 What You'll Need

Before building your calculator, gather this information:

Cost information:

- Product cost (what you pay your supplier at Balogun, Aba, Kano or on Shopinbos)
- Transport and delivery costs (getting stock to you, and getting orders to customers)
- Packaging (nylon, boxes, branded stickers)
- Platform or marketplace fees (Jumia, Konga, your store platform)
- Payment fees (Paystack, Flutterwave and others charge a small percentage per payment)
- Marketing spend per product

Business goals:

- Target profit margin percentage
- What competitors charge for similar products
- The minimum profit you will accept per sale

You do not need fancy software. A free Google Sheets or Excel spreadsheet works perfectly, even on your phone.

03 Building Your Pricing Calculator: Step-by-Step

Step 1: Create your cost column

Open a new spreadsheet and list every cost of selling one item. Be thorough, because hidden costs kill profit. Include:

- Product cost
- Transport to bring stock to you (bus fare, haulage, agent fees for imports)
- Delivery to the customer (if you do not charge it separately)
- Packaging
- Marketplace fees (percentage)
- Payment fees (percentage)
- Ad cost per item (monthly ad spend divided by items sold that month)

Step 2: Calculate total cost

Add all these costs to get your true cost per item. This is the least you must charge just to break even. Many beginners forget costs like failed pay-on-delivery trips, returns or platform fees, then wonder why they are not making money.

Step 3: Add your profit margin

Decide on your target margin. Many small sellers aim for somewhere around 25–40%, but it depends on your product. Divide your total cost by (1 minus your margin as a decimal).

For example: Bisi sells adire shirts. If her total cost is ₦10,000 and she wants a 35% margin, she divides ₦10,000 by 0.65 = ₦15,385 selling price.

Step 4: Round to a nice price

Round to a price that looks good to buyers. Instead of ₦15,385, Bisi might charge ₦14,999 or ₦15,500, depending on her brand and what competitors charge. Round numbers like ₦15,000 also make bank transfers and change easier.

Step 5: Add a comparison section

Add columns to compare your price with competitors on Instagram, Jumia, Jiji or Konga. This reality check shows whether your price makes sense in the market.

04 Using Your Calculator Well

Your calculator is not a set-and-forget tool. Update it as costs change. Fuel prices go up, delivery fees change, the exchange rate moves and supplier prices rise. Review it every month to make sure your prices still protect your profit.

Test different margins. Your calculator shows you instantly how a 30% or 40% margin changes your price. This helps when competition is tight or you are planning a sale for Black Friday or Detty December.

On Shopinbos, you can find products from verified Nigerian suppliers and see their prices before you list them in your store, which makes it easier to plug real costs into your calculator. It is free to start; see shopinbos.com/pricing.

05 Quick Tips for Calculator Success

Start with a safe margin. It is easier to lower prices than to raise them after launch. Add a buffer of 5–10% to your costs for surprises like returns, damaged goods or a sudden price rise from your supplier.

Use the calculator for every product, not just your first batch. As you add new items, using the same method keeps your whole store profitable.

Do not let the calculator replace market research. If your price is much higher than competitors, find out why. Either your costs are too high (maybe you need a cheaper supplier), or you need to show customers extra value, like better quality or faster delivery.

Compare what you planned with what actually happened. After a few months of sales, check your calculator against real numbers. Update it with your actual ad costs, returns and fees.

06 Your Next Steps

Create your pricing calculator today. Enter the numbers for three products you are thinking of selling. Calculate the prices, then check whether customers in your market will pay them.

This simple exercise shows which products can make good profit and which may struggle. It is better to find out now than after spending your money on stock.

Pricing does not have to be complicated. With a simple calculator and real cost numbers, you will set prices with confidence and build a profitable online business from day one.

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